Ask Me Anything: The ORCID Board

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- Welcome & Introduction
- Role & Responsibilities of the ORCID Board
- Nomination Process & Criteria
- ORCID Researcher Advisory Council (ORAC)
- Q&A

ORCID Introduction

ORCID Connects Research and Researchers

- Independent not-for-profit open to participation by all
- Registry launched in 2012
- Guided by our values and founding principles
- Committed to making FAIR Open data available via our Public API and Annual Public Data File

ORCID provides three main services

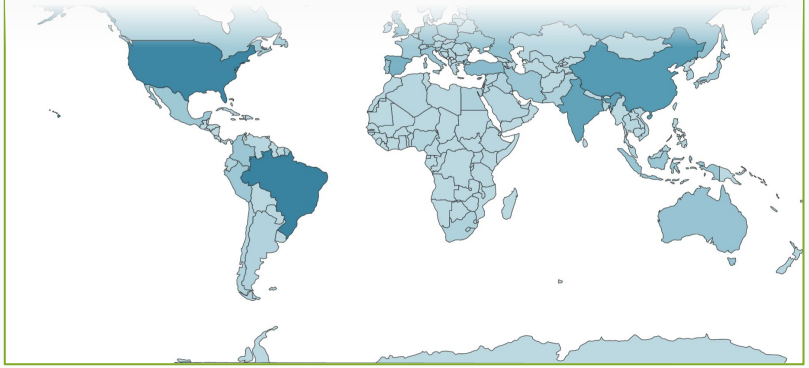
1. The ORCID iD
A unique, persistent identifier (PID) free of charge to researchers (e.g. https://orcid.org/0000-0002-1108-3660)

2. An ORCID record
A digital CV/profile connected to the ORCID iD, that can include employment, education, funding, peer review, research output and other metadata

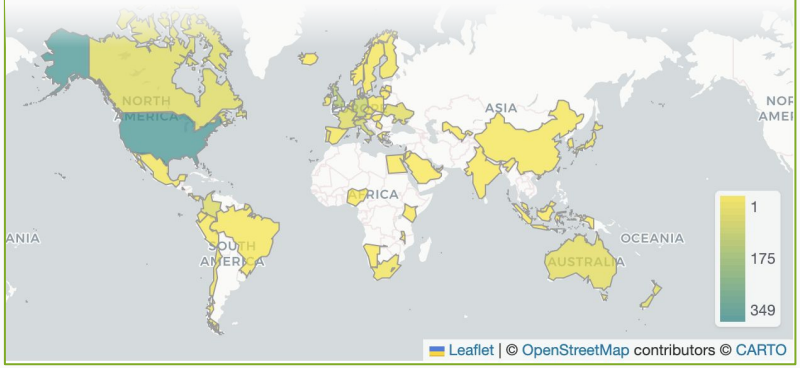
3. The ORCID APIs
A set of Application Programming Interfaces (APIs), as well as the services and support of communities of practice enabling interoperability between an ORCID record and member organizations

We continue to broaden our adoption around the world

Users in 250 countries
Every country on the planet!



Member organizations in 63 countries
28 national consortia and 1 regional consortium



Yearly Active Researchers
9.67 Million

Active Integrated Systems
6,159

Organizational Members
1,451

Data collected on 29 May 2025
Updated data available at https://info.orcid.org/orcid-statistics/

Where we want to go

ORCID's vision is a world where **all who participate** in research, scholarship, and innovation are **uniquely identified** and **connected to their contributions** across **disciplines, borders, and time.**

How we are going to get there

ORCID's mission is to **enable transparent** and **trustworthy connections** between **researchers**, their **contributions**, and their **affiliations** by providing a **unique, persistent identifier** for **individuals** to use as they engage in **research, scholarship, and innovation activities**.

Everything we do is guided by our values and founding principles

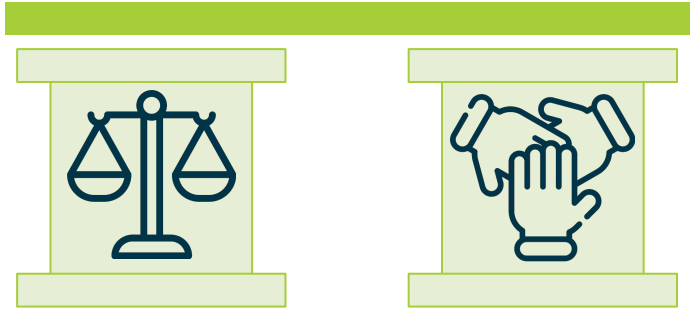
Our Values

Our Founding Principles

1. ORCID will work to support the creation of a permanent, clear, and unambiguous record of research and scholarly communication by enabling reliable attribution of authors and contributors.
2. ORCID will transcend discipline, geographic, national, and institutional boundaries.
3. Participation in ORCID is open to any organization that has an interest in research and scholarly communications.
4. Access to ORCID services will be based on transparent and non-discriminatory terms posted on the ORCID website.
5. Researchers will be able to create, edit, and maintain an ORCID identifier and record free of charge.
6. Researchers will control the defined privacy settings of their own ORCID record data.
7. All data contributed to ORCID by researchers or claimed by them will be available in standard formats for free download (subject to the researchers' own privacy settings) that are updated once a year and released under a CC0 waiver.
8. All software developed by ORCID will be publicly released under an Open Source Software license approved by the Open Source Initiative. For the software it adopts, ORCID will prefer Open Source.
9. ORCID identifiers and record data (subject to privacy settings) will be made available via a combination of no-charge and for-a-fee APIs and services. Any fees will be set to ensure the sustainability of ORCID as a not-for-profit, charitable organization focused on the long-term persistence of the ORCID system.
10. ORCID will be governed by representatives from a broad cross-section of stakeholders, the majority of whom are not-for-profit, and will strive for maximal transparency by publicly posting summaries of all Board meetings and annual financial reports.

ORCID was built from the ground up to earn the broadest possible trust of the communities we serve

- Legal incorporation as US non-profit entity
- Membership organization open to all
- Governed by board elected by our members
- Legally binding membership agreements
- Privacy policy regulated by GDPR and other national regulations
- Legally binding employment agreements, code of conduct, etc



Legal Constructs | **Social Constructs**

- Founding principles and values
- Commitment to researcher control
- Open source software and FAIR open data
- Equitable, sustainable business model
- Holding ourselves accountable by working openly
- Continuous community engagement and dialogue

Board Roles & Responsibilities

We are a US non-profit corporation governed by an independent Board of Directors

Board responsibilities

- Developing and regularly updating ORCID's strategic plan
- Reviewing high-level organizational goals and policies to support that plan
- Overseeing ORCID's organizational and financial performance
- Ensuring ORCID has financial resources to achieve its mission
- Monitoring Board function
- Appointing the Executive Director and reviewing their performance
- Serving as a community advocate for ORCID

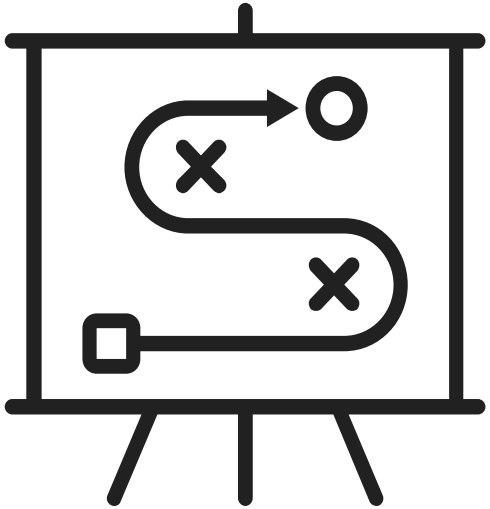
The Board has an oversight role and provides ORCID with strategic direction.

	Board	Executive Director
STAFF	• Hires and Reviews Executive Director	• Hires and reviews all other staff • Sets compensation within Board-approved budget
STRATEGY	• Sets the strategic vision/plan with input from the ED	• Executes on strategic plan
PROGRAMS	• Sets metrics for and evaluates programs	• Develops and implements programs that align with mission and strategic plan • Reports on program status and performance to Board
FINANCE	• Approves budget and material variances • Approves fiscal policies and procedures • Sets strategy for long-term sustainability	• Provides Board with periodic reporting prepared with Treasurer • Implements fiscal controls • With help from Board, implements sustainability strategy
OPERATIONS	• Board approves policies related to risk management (e.g., level of insurance)	• Executive Director informs Board of major operational decisions

Director Duties

In exercising discretion and and control over ORCID, Directors are bound by fiduciary duties:

- Duty of Care
- Duty of Loyalty
- Duty of Obedience



Duty of Care

A Director owes a duty to exercise reasonable care and prudence when s/he makes a decision as a member of the Board.

- Attend meetings, ask hard questions, get the information you need
- May rely on information from experts
- Collective decision making

Duty of Loyalty

A Director must give undivided allegiance and act in ORCID's best interest when making decisions affecting ORCID.

- Make decisions as an ORCID Director not an institutional representative
- Disclose conflicts of interest and refrain from deliberating and voting when conflicted
- Don't use information obtained as a Director for personal benefit
- Maintain the confidentiality of non-public Board information

Duty of Obedience

Directors must at all times be faithful to ORCID's mission when making decisions for ORCID and acting on ORCID's behalf.

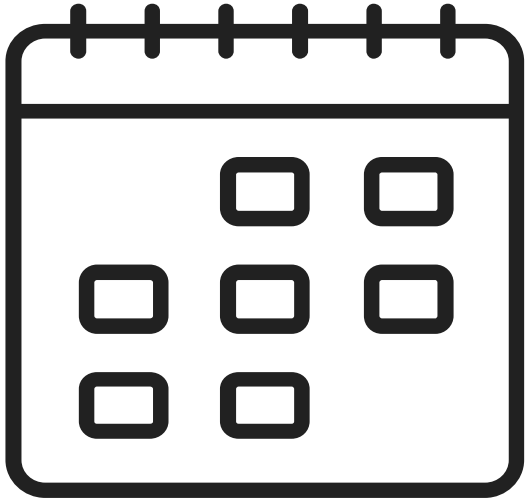
- Have a firm understanding of ORCID' mission
- Take actions that are consistent with the central goals of the organization
- Ensure that funds raised to fulfill ORCID's mission are spent accordingly

Board Time Commitment

- **Board Meetings:** Two 2-day in-person meetings (March/September) with travel required, plus two 4-hour virtual meetings (May/November) split across multiple days for global time zones

- **Committee Work:** Board members must serve on 1-2 committees annually, with virtual meetings typically held 4 times per year for 1 hour each, often outside standard working hours

- **Preparation:** Review meeting materials in advance and make substantive contributions to both Board and committee work



Board Meeting Attendance Fund

- A Board Meeting Attendance Fund helps cover travel costs for directors whose organizations cannot support their participation.
- ORCID covers the travel costs for Researcher-Directors to attend in-person meetings.

Nominations Process

We are governed by our community

Our board is elected by our members

- Elections are held each year
- Up to 16 seats on the Board
- Board members serve up to two 3-year terms

- 10–14 representatives of member organizations
- Must be employees, directors or officers of member org
- Majority from non-profit orgs

- 1–2 independent researchers
- Do not have to be affiliated with member orgs

Purpose of the Elections

- Ensure that our community has the opportunity to nominate individuals for consideration by the Nominating Committee for election to the Board.
- Ensure that individuals in our community, as specified by ORCID's bylaws, are provided an opportunity to vote for ORCID board members.
- Encourage individuals to engage in the election process through effective procedures and communications.
- Deliver an auditable process that is compliant with legal obligations.

Election Process

- Elections are by majority vote of the ORCID members on a slate presented by the Nominating Committee following approval by the Board.

- Write-in candidates may be nominated by any group of 20 or more Members (including no more than one member of a specific Consortium) no more than 30 days after the slate is announced.

- If write-in candidates are received, elections are by plurality vote among the slate and any write-in candidate.

Nomination Criteria

- This year, we are looking to fill **up to four Member-Director board seats** and **one Researcher-Director seat**.

- In seeking perspectives and skills complementary to those of continuing Board members, the Nominating Committee will be specifically looking for candidates who meet two or more of the following:
  - Have a track record of advocating on behalf of ORCID within their region and community
  - Are knowledgeable about ORCID and/or other scholarly infrastructure services
  - Represent one of the following stakeholder groups: funders, government, or policy makers
  - Have financial expertise
  - Have experience in organizational governance

Election Timeline

Date	Activity
22 May	Call for Board nominations
27 June	Closing date for Board nominations
July – August	Nominating Committee to review nominations
17-18 September	Nominating Committee presents slate for Board approval
1 October	Slate made public
31 October	Closing date for alternative nominations
3 November	Voting opens
20 November	Voting closes, results announced at virtual members' meeting
March 2026	Elected members start their term at the first Board meeting of the year. (Tentatively March; Exact date to be confirmed)

ORCID Researcher Advisory Council (ORAC)

The ORCID Board created ORAC to to elevate researcher perspectives in ORCID decision making.

- ORCID was established in 2021 and was launched in 2022.
- ORAC is made up of a diverse group of researchers who provide feedback and advice to ORCID board and staff.
- ORAC meets virtually twice a year, with additional meetings scheduled as needed.
- ORAC is co-chaired by the Researcher-Director member(s) of the ORCID Board. The Product Director and Executive Director are ex-officio members of the Council.

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